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Domolite 4 Tent By Kelty
The Domolite 4 person tent will set up in less than five minutes, measures 90"x101" in the floor area, weighs only 11 lbs 11oz and stands 58" in the center. The near vertical side walls provide a spacious interior. Call HTC for sale prices on all other Kelty Tents.
$159.95
$259.95 List

Equidome 6 Family Tent By Eureka !
The Equidome 6 is a Self-Supporting rectangular 4 pole dome with a center spider which gives more interior volume than the traditional A-frame. Sleeps 5-6 happy campers, measures 9'6" x 9'6" in the floor area, stands 6'11" in the center and weighs 16Lbs. 9 oz.
$259.95
$359.95 List

Meteor Light CD Backpacking Tent By Sierra Designs
Three poles of equal length make the Meteor Light CD free standing and easy to pitch. Sleeps 2 happy campers, weighs only 6 lbs, measures 98" x 60" in the floor area and stands 46" in the center. The included vestibule adds an additional 14 sq. ft.. Call HTC for sale prices on all other Sierra Designs Tents 1998.
$199.95
$269.95 List

Twin Peaks III Sleeping Bag by American Quest Adult Size Cotton Liner $19.95 $39.95 List
Idaho Hiking Boots by HI-TEC Mens & Ladies Sizes $24.95 $44.95 List
Yukon Frame Pack by Kelty for weekend backcountry trips capacity 3485 Cu.In. $69.95 $109.95 List

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Graduate is gladly standing on ceremony

By Tatsha Robertson
GLOBE STAFF

For years, Hugo Ascolillo would stare at his college diploma on the wall of his East Boston home and imagine how it would have felt to receive it in front of his family and classmates.

He missed that chance in 1976 when he suffered a heart attack two weeks before the ceremony.

But today, Ascolillo, 70, a retired postal worker, will be honored along with 640 other Suffolk University graduates during its commencement ceremony at The FleetCenter.

"I said 'I still yearn to have that degree handed to me, to shake the president's hand, to look at all the students in the audience. I think they applaud – don't they?' "

In 1976, the university president presented him with his diploma in the hospital.

GLOBE STAFF PHOTO / JOHN TLUMACKI

A hospitalized Hugo Ascolillo received his degree from Suffolk President Thomas A. Fulham in 1976 (above). He'll go through a more traditional ceremony today.

When Suffolk University president David J. Sargent heard Ascolillo's story, he immediately agreed to allow him to walk with the graduating class today, said Tony Ferullo, a spokesman for the university.

The 1976 episode was the second time that Ascolillo missed the chance to experience the pomp and circumstance of a graduation.

He was 17 in 1946, just weeks from graduating from English High School, when he was called to serve in the Navy. His brother accepted his diploma.

When he returned to East Boston in 1948, he worked with his father in the North End, making novelty shoes for women. But when the factory moved to New Hampshire, he realized he would need a trade and enrolled in Suffolk University.

He married the next year and the pressure of supporting a small family, working two jobs, and going to school was too much. He dropped out of college in 1950, but always vowed to return.

By 1971, about the time he helped organize The American Postal Worker's Union AFL-CIO, he decided he needed to be more polished as he sat with managers and lawyers.

"I'm no genius, but at least they would know I'm educated. They would know I'm a man of letters," Ascolillo said.

He returned to Suffolk University, majoring in government. He stayed focused on his studies, but his health suffered. It all seem to hit him one warm June day as he was working in his East Boston house.

He ended up in the hospital for weeks, missing his chance to graduate with his classmates. But to his surprise, Thomas A. Fulham, then president of Suffolk University, visited him at Massachusetts General Hospital.

"I don't want to diminish the honor Suffolk gave me that day. The president leaning over my bed and handing me a degree. I will never forget that," he said.

But the cap-and-gown ceremony today will be special too.

"I will be part of the last graduating class of the century," said Acolillo.

Commencements

Yesterday

■ Assumption College
Worcester
Graduates: 557
Degrees: Associate, bachelor, master
Speaker: Jane Swift, lieutenant governor of Massachusetts
Honorary degrees: Swift, the Rev. Richard Ryscavage, national director of Jesuit Refugee Service and secretary for Jesuit International Ministries

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■ Bridgewater State College
Bridgewater
Graduates: 842
Degrees: Bachelor, master
Speaker: Jeff Corwin, creator, producer and host of Disney's "Going Wild with Jeff Corwin"
Honorary degrees: Corwin and Mary Hart Cogan, chairwoman of Bridgewater State College's Annual Fund

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■ Endicott College
Beverly
Graduates: 256
Degrees: Associate, bachelor, master
Speaker: Lester Strong, WHDH-TV news anchor
Honorary degrees: Strong; A. Joseph Callahan Jr., chairman of the Endicott trustees; Mary Ellen Fogarty Kennedy, former president of the Endicott Alumni Association

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■ Mount Holyoke College
South Hadley
Graduates: 450
Degrees: Bachelor
Speaker: Anna Quindlen, novelist and journalist
Honorary degrees: Quindlen; Ama Ata Aidoo, Ghanaian feminist writer; Frances H. Miller, lawyer and author; Roy Neuberger, art collector; Nancy J. Vickers, president of Bryn Mawr College

...

■ University of New Hampshire
Durham, N.H.
Graduates: 2,400
Degrees: Bachelor, master, doctorate
Speaker: Al Gore, vice president of the United States
Honorary degrees: Gore; Dennis Koslowski, chairman and CEO of Tyco International; Stephen Wolnek, international president of the United Synagogue of Conservative Judaism; Robert Marshall, retired justice of Salem District Court

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■ Salem State College
Salem
Graduates: 1,320
Degrees: Bachelor, master
Speaker: Ira Jackson, executive vice president of BankBoston
Honorary degrees: Kenneth Granderson, founder and CEO of Inner-City Software; Sister Kathleen Crowley, former director of Salem State Campus Ministries; Representative J. Michael Ruane, vice chairman, House Ways and Means Committee; Beverly Tatum, dean of Mount Holyoke College; Richard Trask, archivist and researcher

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■ Western New England College
Springfield
Graduates: 873
Degrees: Bachelor, master
Speaker: P.A. "Takis" Argentinis, president, chairman and CEO of Elan Technologies
Honorary degrees: None

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■ Wheaton College
Norton
Graduates: 287
Degrees: Bachelor
Speaker: Mark Whitaker, Newsweek editor
Honorary degrees: Whitaker; Dr. Nancy Kernan, assistant chief of bone marrow transplants at Memorial Sloan-Kettering Cancer Center; Joanna DeHaven Underwood, founder and president of IN-FORM, Inc.; Harry V. Keefe Jr., trustee and investment banker; Nancy Monick Budd, Wheaton president's commission; William Budd, Wheaton trustee

...

■ Worcester Polytechnic Institute
Worcester
Graduates: 828
Degrees: Bachelor, master, doctorate
Speaker: Eric Hahn, founder of Inventures Group
Honorary degrees: Hahn; Douglas G. Noiles, consultant in mechanical engineering; Paul Severino, chairman and CEO of NetCentric Corp.; Bruce R. Bond, chairman, CEO and president of PictureTel Corp.; T.S. Lin, president of Tatung Institute of Technology, Taiwan

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